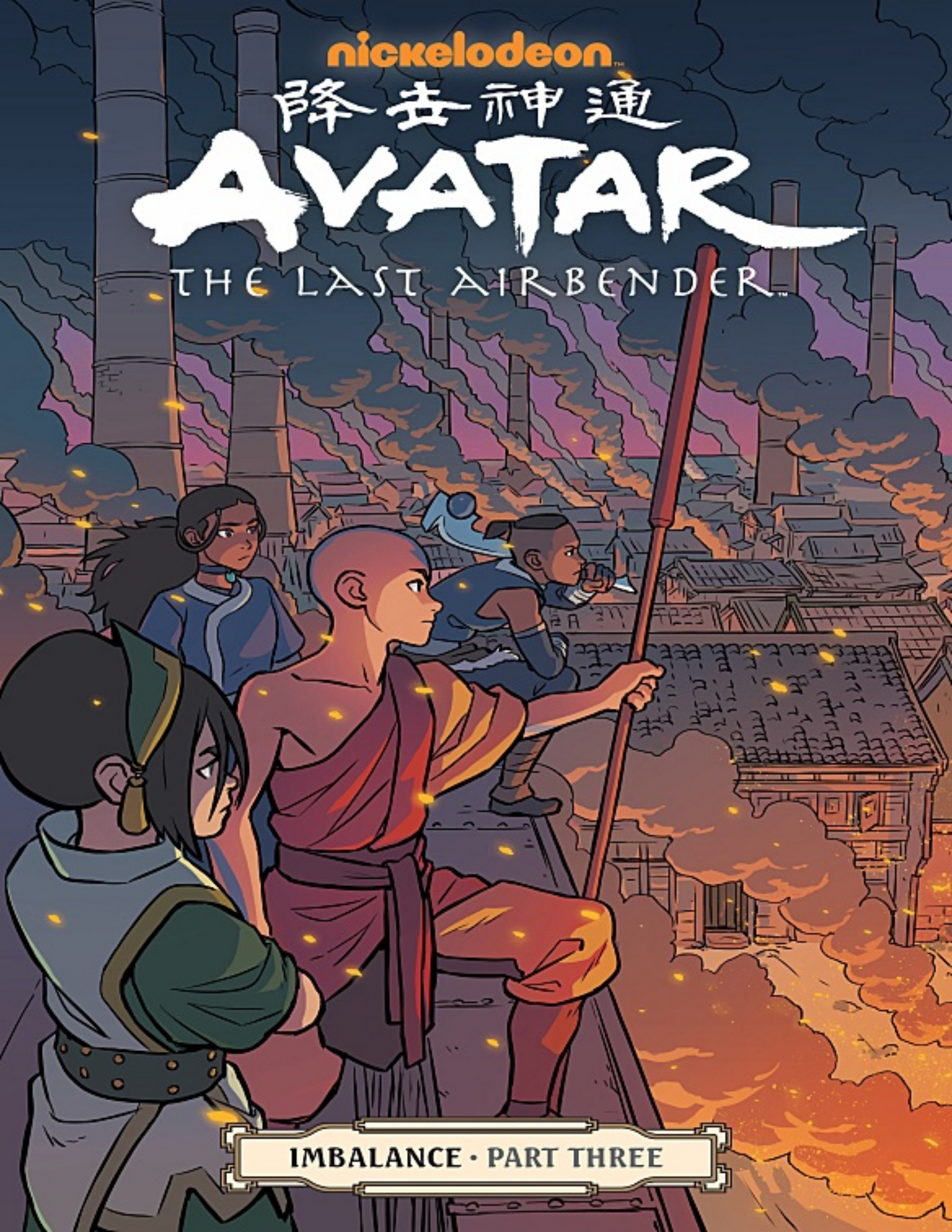


nickelodeon™

降世神通

AVATAR

THE LAST AIRBENDER™



IMBALANCE • PART THREE

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AVATAR

THE LAST AIRBENDER™

Created by

Bryan Konietzko

Michael Dante DiMartino



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IMBALANCE • PART THREE

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WHY'D EVERYONE
GET QUIET ALL OF
A SUDDEN?



TOPH, YOU
JUST TOLD AANG HE
SHOULD TAKE LILING'S
BENDING AWAY. I THINK
WE'RE ALL A LITTLE
SHOCKED--

WHAT'S TO
BE SHOCKED
ABOUT? IT MAKES
PERFECT SENSE
TO ME.



SHE'S BEEN
PLOTING TO DRIVE
OUT THE NON-BENDERS
WHO LIVE IN CRANEFISH
TOWN! SHE HIRED
CRIMINALS TO BLOW
UP MY DAD'S FACTORY!
NOT TO MENTION ALL
THOSE OTHER
FACTORIES AS WELL.

SHE CAN'T
LEAD A BUNCH
OF BENDER
SUPREMACISTS
IF SHE'S NOT
A BENDER
ANYMORE.



AANG HAS ONLY TAKEN
AWAY SOMEONE'S
BENDING ONCE BEFORE,
AND THAT WAS THE FIRE
LORD! LILING ISN'T HIM!
SHE'S NOT THREATENING
THE WORLD WITH
DESTRUCTION.

NO, SHE'S JUST
THREATENING THIS CITY.
DID YOU MISS THE PART
WHERE I GOT BURIED IN
RUBBLE BECAUSE SHE
BLEW UP MY DAD'S
FACTORY?



WHY ARE
YOU SO UPSET
ABOUT WHAT
I SAID?

TOPH, IT'S TAKING AWAY
SOMEONE'S BENDING.
IT'S REMOVING A PART
OF WHO THEY ARE. IT'S
NOT A DECISION TO BE
MADE LIGHTLY.





IF YOU TAKE AWAY HER BENDING, IS THAT SOMETHING BENDERS WILL BE OKAY WITH? YOU'VE ONLY DONE IT ONCE BEFORE, TO FIRE LORD OZAI.

WHO, EVERYONE AGREES, WAS A VERY BAD PERSON. IT'S FINE HE LOST HIS BENDING, BUT LILING'S DIFFERENT.

OKAY, SHE'S ALSO A VERY BAD PERSON, BUT SHE'S A CIVILIAN. YOU MIGHT BE RISKING YOUR RELATIONSHIP WITH THE BENDER COMMUNITY, AANG.



WELL, WHAT'S YOUR TAKE ON THIS, TWINKLE TOES? YOU'VE BEEN REAL QUIET.



I NEED TO THINK ABOUT THIS.

I'M GOING TO TALK TO LILING. SHE MIGHT BE WILLING TO TELL HER FOLLOWERS TO STOP THEIR ATTACKS.



TALK ALL YOU WANT, THAT LADY ISN'T CHANGING HER MIND.





I DID SPARE
HIS LIFE, AND I SAVED
THE EARTH KINGDOM
TOO. I'LL FIND A WAY
TO RESOLVE *THIS*
CONFLICT PEACEFULLY
AS WELL.



I KNOW WHAT
YOU DID TO THE
FIRE LORD WHEN
YOU "SPARED" HIS
LIFE, AVATAR. YOU
SHOULD HAVE
KILLED HIM.

A LIFE
WITHOUT BENDING
ISN'T WORTH
LIVING.



I WON'T
ALLOW YOU OR
YOUR FOLLOWERS
TO HARM ANY MORE
NON-BENDERS
IN CRANEFISH
TOWN.



WELL THEN,
AVATAR AANG, THE
QUESTION IS HOW
FAR ARE YOU
WILLING TO GO
TO PROTECT
THEM?





NO.
I'M NOT SNEAKING
IN ANYWHERE. WHAT
WE NEED TO DO IS DRAW
THE AVATAR AND HIS
FRIENDS AWAY FROM THE
FACTORY, THEN WE CAN
RESCUE MOM.



WE CAN'T FIGHT
THEM DIRECTLY, SO
WE HAVE TO COME
AT THEM ANOTHER
WAY. AND I THINK I
KNOW HOW.



WHATEVER
IT TAKES TO GET
MOM BACK.



YEAH.
WHATEVER IT
TAKES.



YOU'RE ALWAYS ASKING IF I'M OKAY—NOW IT'S MY TURN. ARE YOU OKAY?



I'M FINE, I JUST DON'T AGREE WITH WHAT TOPH WAS SUGGESTING.



SHE'S NOT WRONG, THOUGH. LILING CAN'T LEAD A BENDER SUPREMACIST MOVEMENT IF SHE'S NOT A BENDER.



ARE YOU REALLY CONSIDERING TAKING HER BENDING AWAY?



I'M NOT SURE. LILING IS SO DETERMINED TO HURT PEOPLE... TAKING AWAY HER BENDING MIGHT BE A NONVIOLENT WAY TO STOP HER.



WATERBENDING IS A BIG PART OF WHO I AM. IT'S ALSO A PART OF MY WATER TRIBE CULTURE. IF I LOST MY BENDING, I'D LOSE A PIECE OF MY IDENTITY.



TAKING AWAY
SOMEONE'S BENDING
MIGHT SEEM NONVIOLENT
WHEN COMPARED TO
OTHER OPTIONS, BUT...
IS IT REALLY? YOU'RE
DESTROYING A PART
OF SOMEONE. AND
THAT FEELS VIOLENT
TO ME.



DO LILING'S
CRIMES FIT THIS
PUNISHMENT? DOES
SHE DESERVE TO
LOSE A PIECE OF
HER IDENTITY?



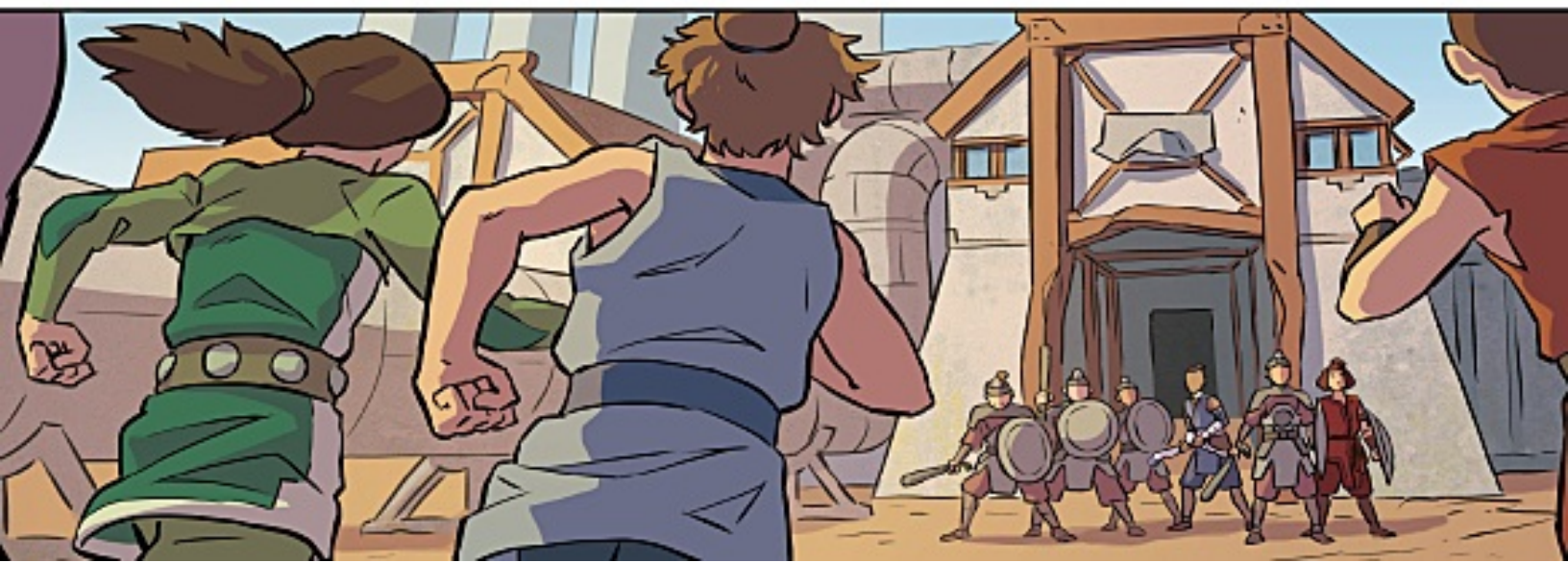
AVATAR
AANG!

WHAT
IS IT?





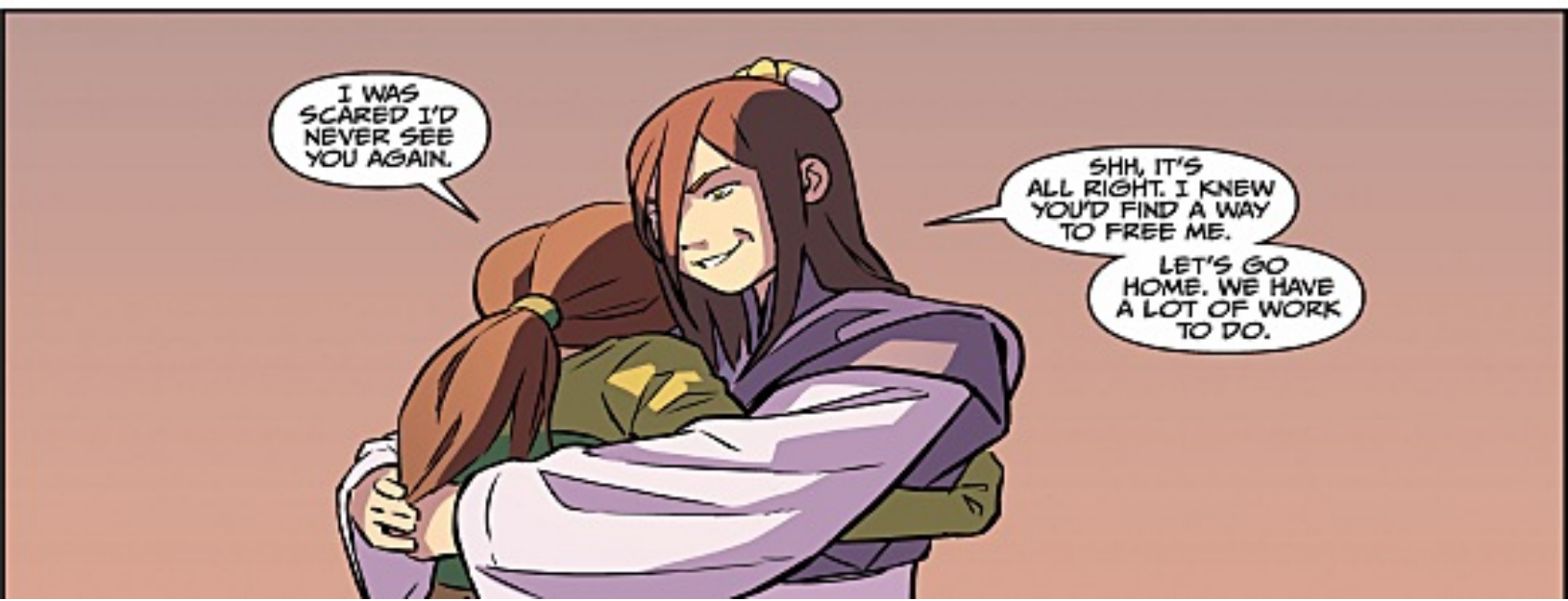






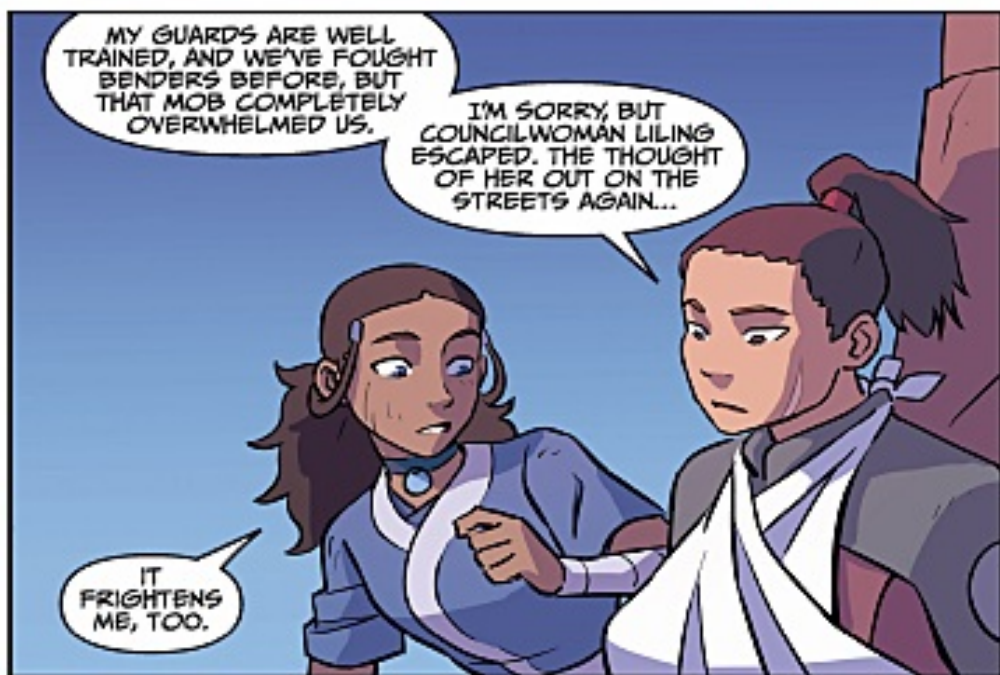








NOW WE KNOW
WHAT THE BUSINESS
COUNCIL ATTACK
WAS REALLY
ABOUT.



MY GUARDS ARE WELL
TRAINED, AND WE'VE FOUGHT
BENDERS BEFORE, BUT
THAT MOB COMPLETELY
OVERWHELMED US.

I'M SORRY, BUT
COUNCILWOMAN LILING
ESCAPED. THE THOUGHT
OF HER OUT ON THE
STREETS AGAIN...

IT
FRIGHTENS
ME, TOO.



AANG ASKED
THE COUNCIL MEMBERS
TO STAY AT THE FACTORY,
WHERE WE CAN PROTECT
THEM. BUT AS LONG AS
LILING AND HER
FOLLOWERS ARE FREE,
EVERY NON-BENDER
IN THE CITY IS IN
DANGER.



SHE ALWAYS SEEMS TO
BE ONE STEP AHEAD OF
US. IT'S FRUSTRATING, I
FEEL LIKE WE NEED TO
BE DOING MORE.

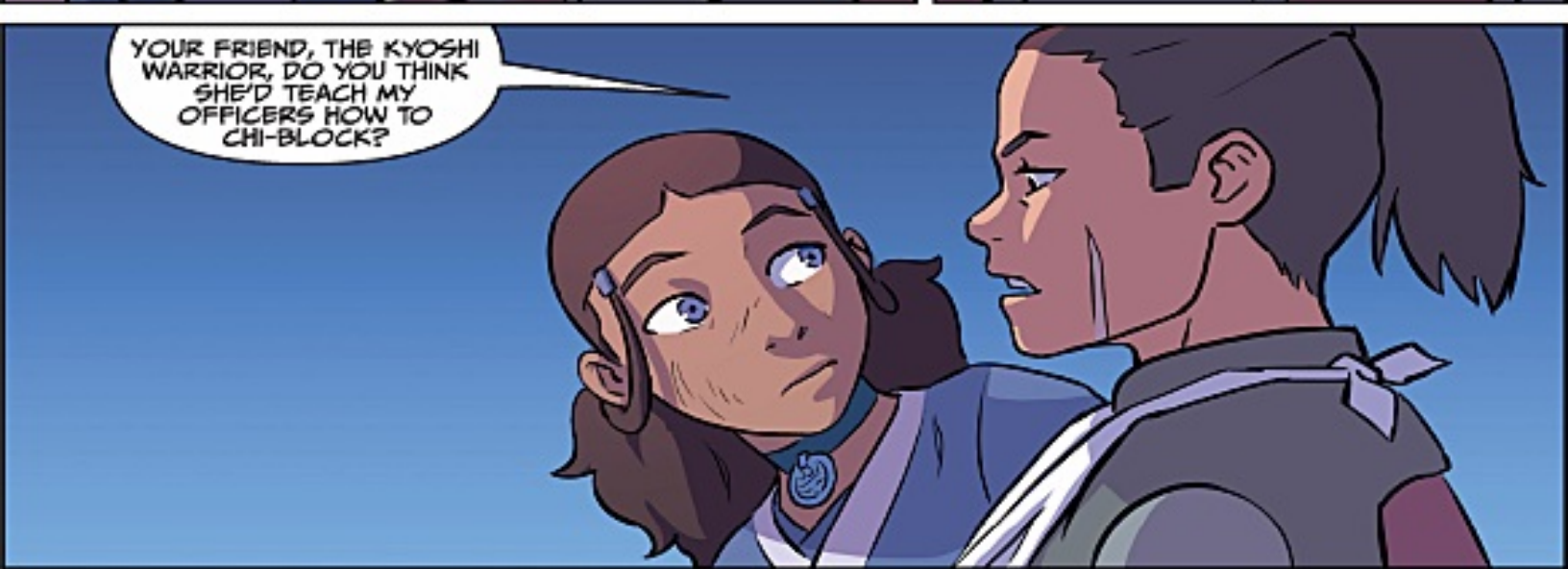
AT LEAST
I CAN HEAL
YOUR ARM.

THANK
YOU.

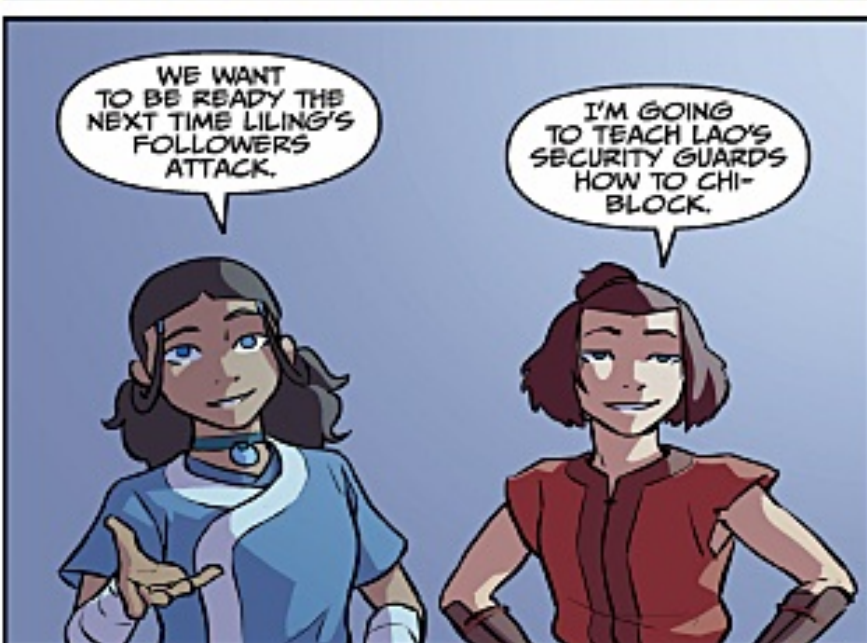


THERE'S
SOMETHING
I WANTED
TO ASK...

WHAT
IS IT?



YOUR FRIEND, THE KYOSHI
WARRIOR, DO YOU THINK
SHE'D TEACH MY
OFFICERS HOW TO
CHI-BLOCK?

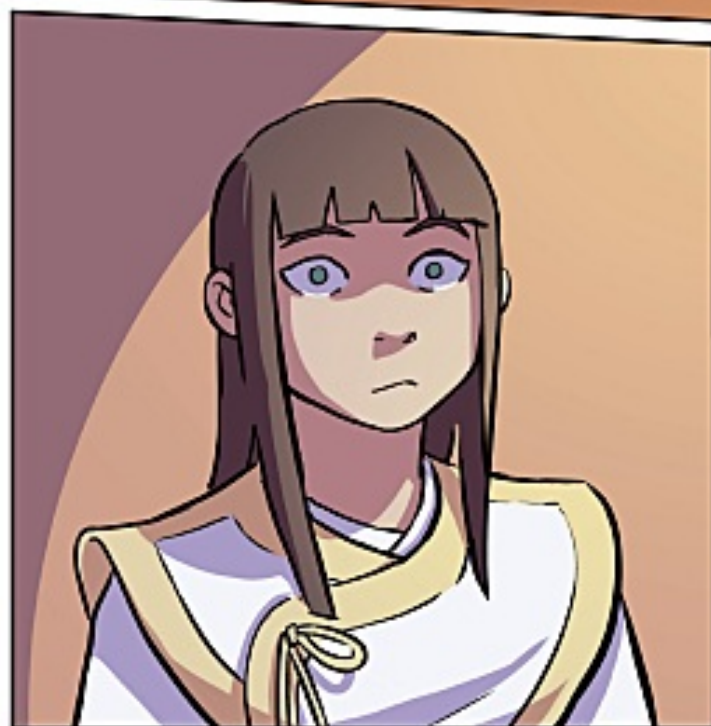






I WON'T LET WHAT HAPPENED TO US IN BA SING SE HAPPEN AGAIN! WE LOST **EVERYTHING** WHEN THAT CITY FELL TO THE FIRE NATION! OUR HOME, OUR FRIENDS, **EVERYTHING** THAT WAS OURS.

YOU REMEMBER WHAT THAT WAS LIKE, DON'T YOU, RU? FLEEING THE CITY WITH ONLY THE CLOTHES ON OUR BACKS?



AND WHY DID BA SING SE
FALL SO EASILY TO THE
FIRE NATION? WHY WAS IT
SO EASY FOR PRINCESS
AZULA TO INFILTRATE ITS
WALLS AND GAIN
CONTROL OF THE
DAI LI?

TELL
ME WHY,
RU.

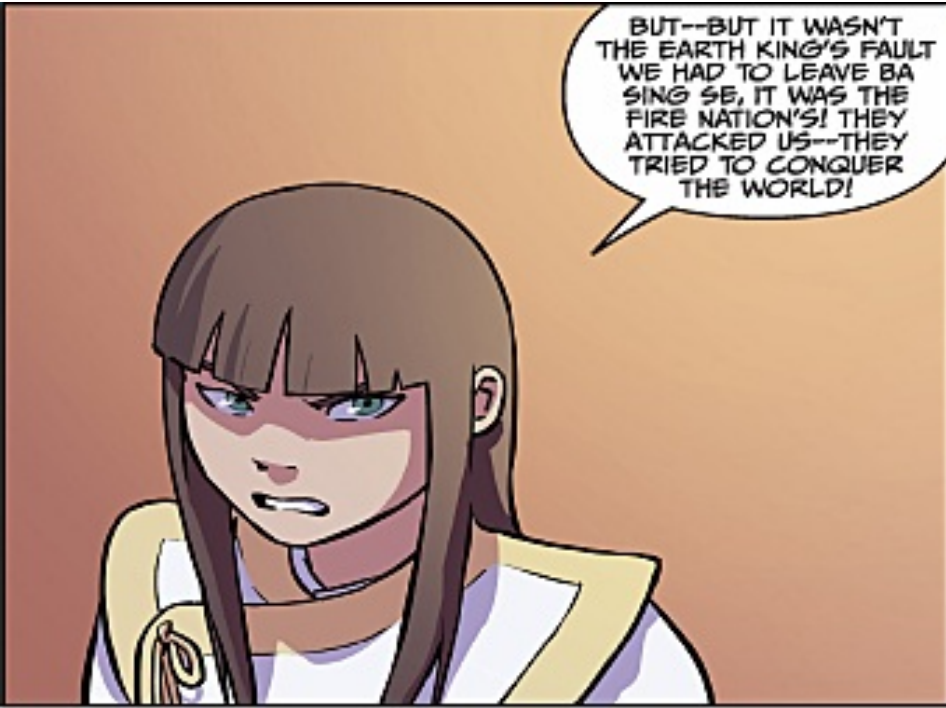


BECAUSE--
BECAUSE THE
EARTH KING WAS A
NON-BENDER.

THAT'S RIGHT! IF HE WAS
A BENDER, HE WOULD'VE
BEEN ABLE TO CONTROL
HIS AGENTS! HE WOULD'VE
BEEN ABLE TO PROTECT
HIS CITY.

I WON'T LET NON-BENDERS
RUIN THE LIFE I'VE BUILT IN
CRANEFISH TOWN, THE WAY A
NON-BENDER RUINED OUR
LIVES IN BA SING SE.

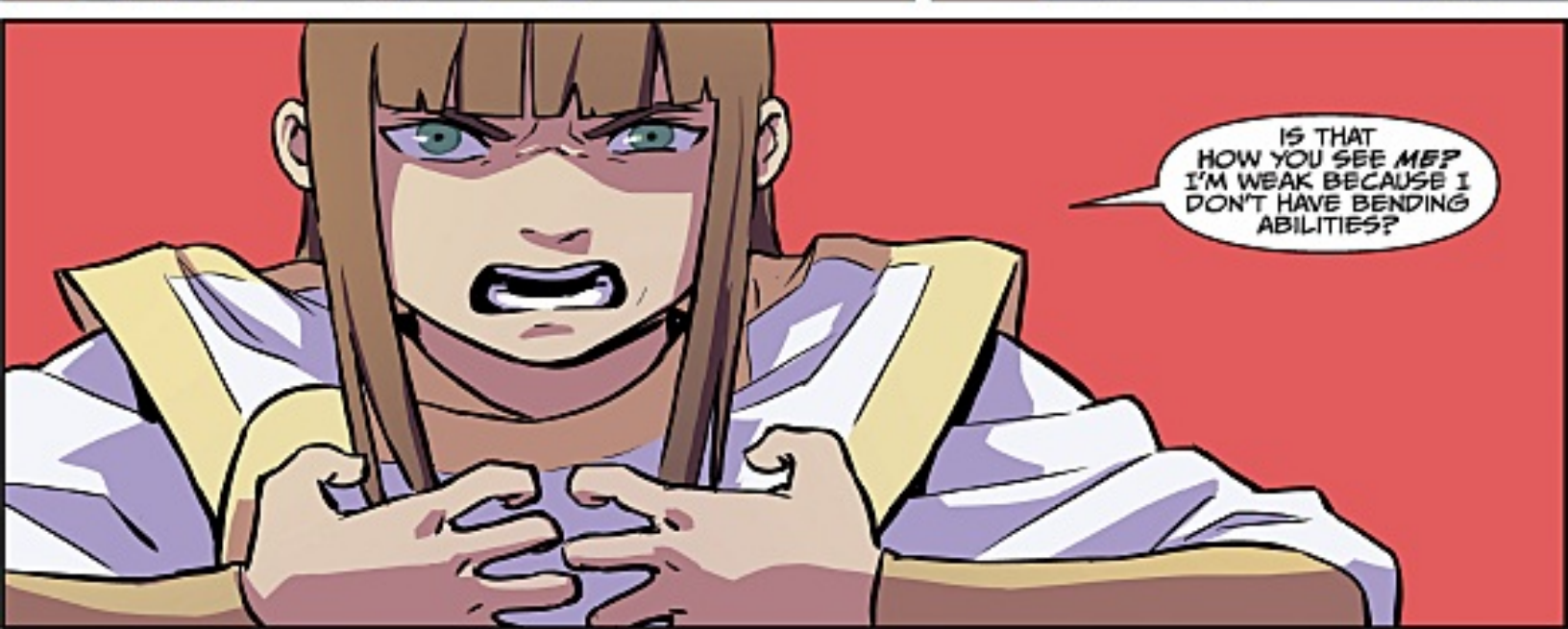
WE'RE STAYING
HERE. WE'RE
FIGHTING FOR
OUR HOME.



BUT--BUT IT WASN'T
THE EARTH KING'S FAULT
WE HAD TO LEAVE BA
SING SE, IT WAS THE
FIRE NATION'S! THEY
ATTACKED US--THEY
TRIED TO CONQUER
THE WORLD!



THE FIRE LORD
WAS ONLY DOING WHAT
ANY STRONG BENDER
LEADER WOULD DO. HE
WAS EXPLOITING A
WEAKNESS.



IS THAT
HOW YOU SEE *ME*?
I'M WEAK BECAUSE I
DON'T HAVE BENDING
ABILITIES?



RU...YOU MUST
UNDERSTAND.

I LOVE YOU.
I LOVE YOU JUST
AS MUCH AS YOUR
SISTER.

BUT THIS IS THE WAY
THE WORLD WORKS.
BENDERS ARE POWERFUL,
NON-BENDERS AREN'T.
IT'S JUST HOW
THINGS ARE.

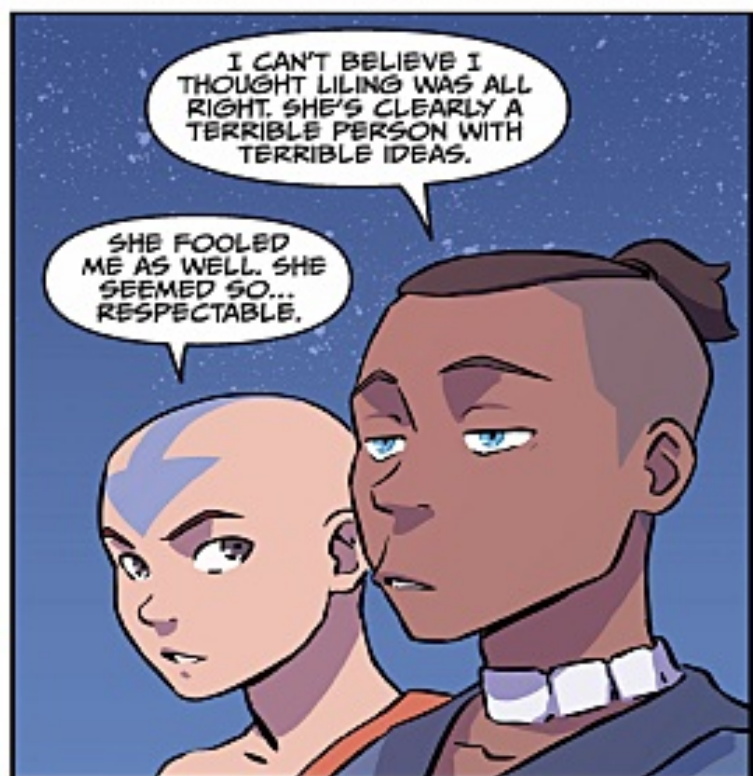
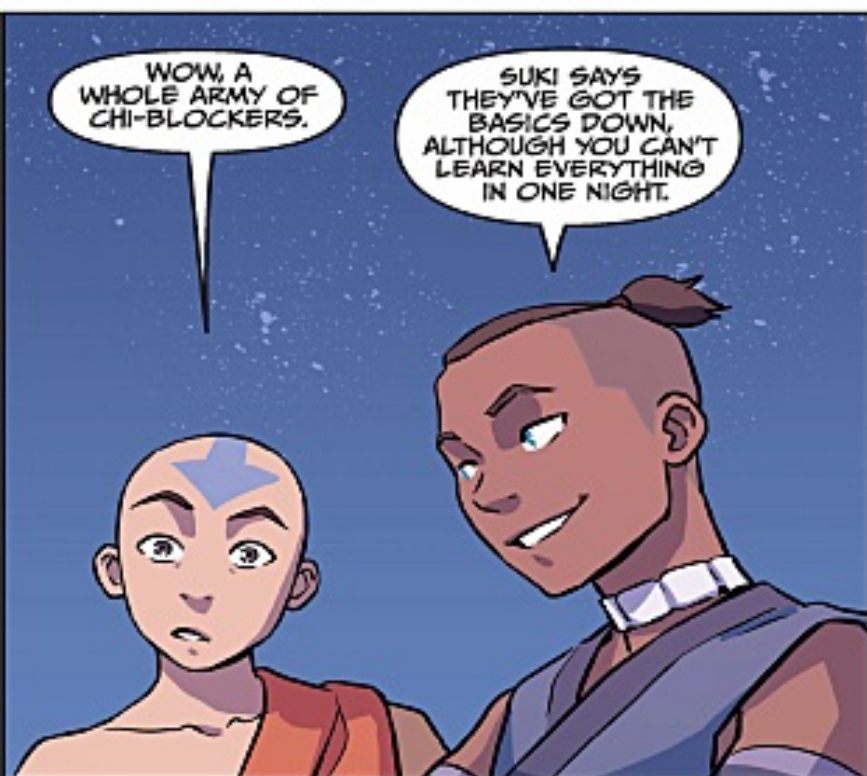
AND IT'S BEST
FOR NON-BENDERS
IF THEY RECOGNIZE
THAT.



NOW UNPACK
THOSE BAGS.
WE'RE STAYING
HERE.

TOMORROW I'LL
TAKE A GROUP OF
BENDERS TO EARTHEN
FIRE INDUSTRIES AND
DRIVE THE AVATAR
FROM OUR HOME.





IF I'D DONE WHAT TOPH SAID AND TAKEN AWAY LILING'S BENDING WHEN WE'D CAPTURED HER, EVERYTHING MIGHT BE OVER BY NOW.



THIS BENDER SUPREMACIST MOVEMENT IS MORE THAN ONE PERSON. REMEMBER ALL THE BENDERS WE SAW AT THAT UNDERGROUND RALLY? SOME OF THEM WERE EVEN ON THE BUSINESS COUNCIL.



ARE YOU WILLING TO TAKE AWAY THE BENDING OF ALL LILING'S FOLLOWERS, TOO?



ARGH! NO, OF COURSE NOT.



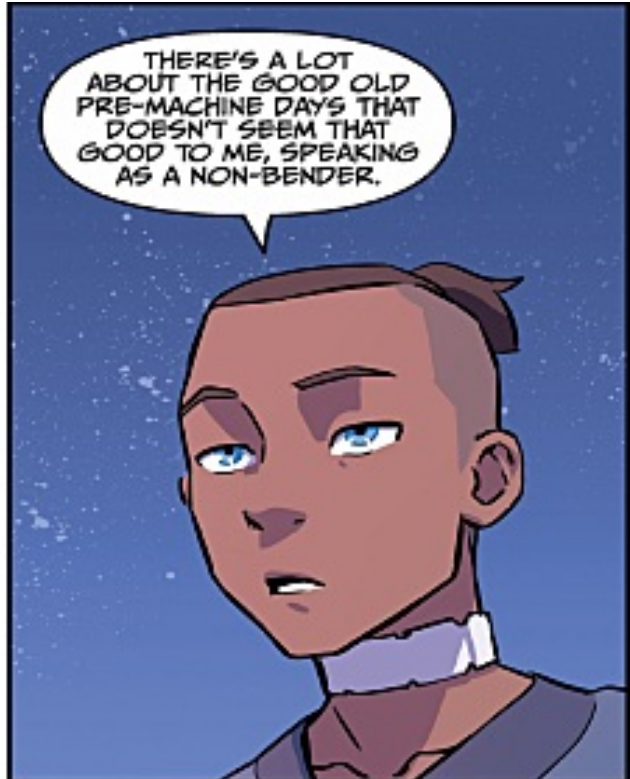
ALL OF THIS... THE POLLUTION, THE TENSION BETWEEN BENDERS AND NON-BENDERS, IT STARTED WITH THE FACTORY MACHINES.

IT'S THE SAME AS WHEN THE FIRE NATION ATTACKED THE OTHER NATIONS USING TANKS AND STEAM SHIPS. THEY NEVER WOULD'VE GONE TO WAR IF THEY DIDN'T HAVE THAT TECHNOLOGY.

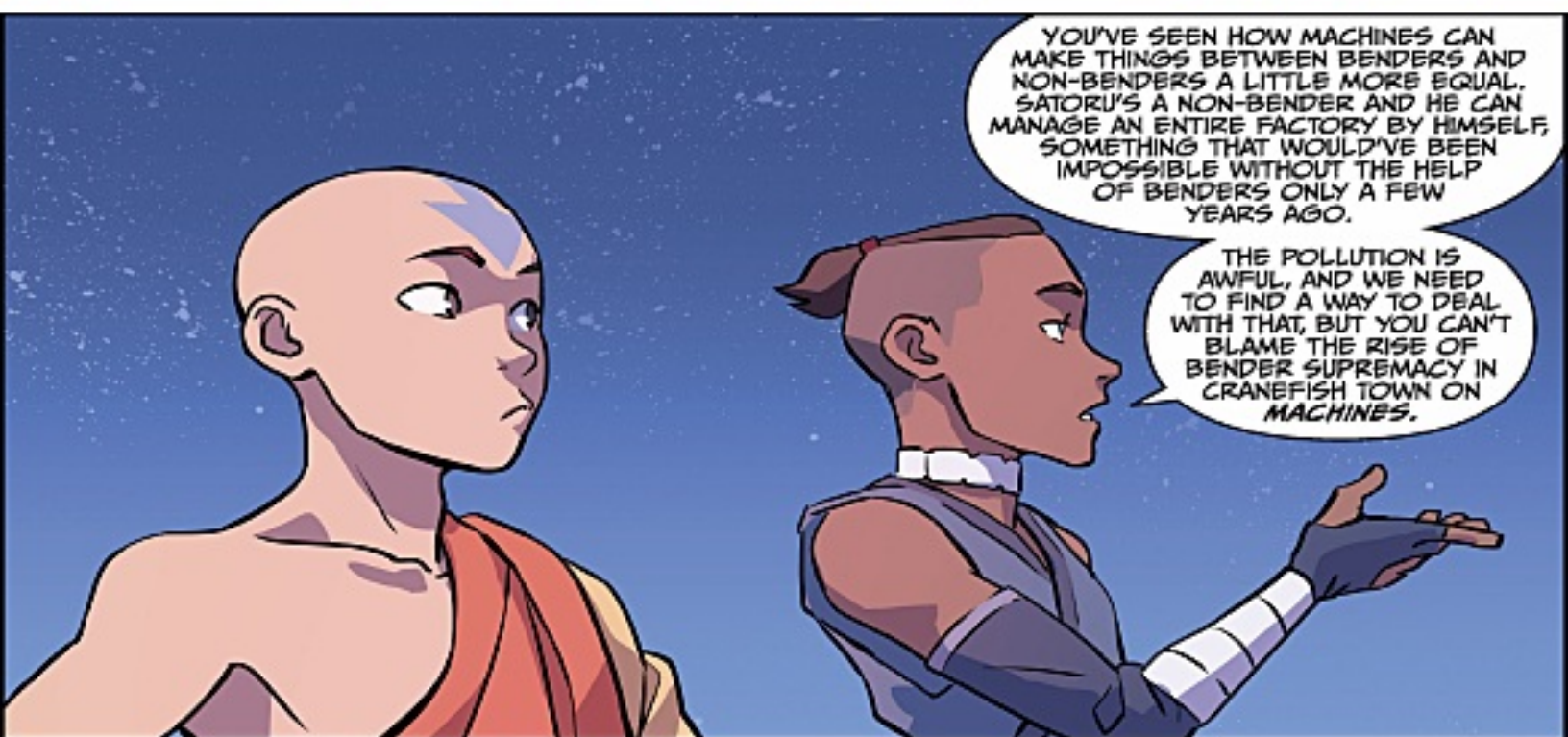




IT WAS BETTER WHEN PEOPLE AT LEAST *TRIED* TO LIVE IN HARMONY WITH NATURE. ALL THESE MACHINES DO IS CAUSE POLLUTION AND PROBLEMS.



THERE'S A LOT ABOUT THE GOOD OLD PRE-MACHINE DAYS THAT DOESN'T SEEM THAT GOOD TO ME, SPEAKING AS A NON-BENDER.

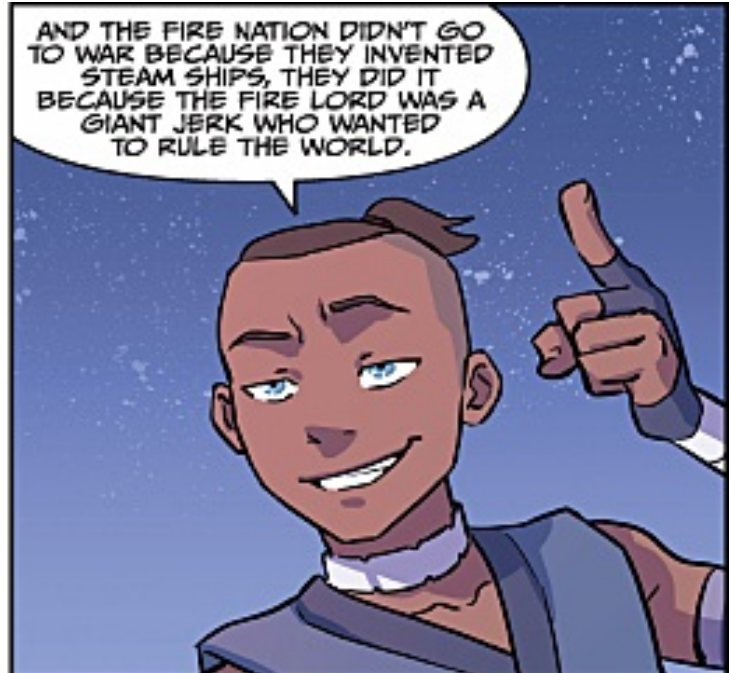


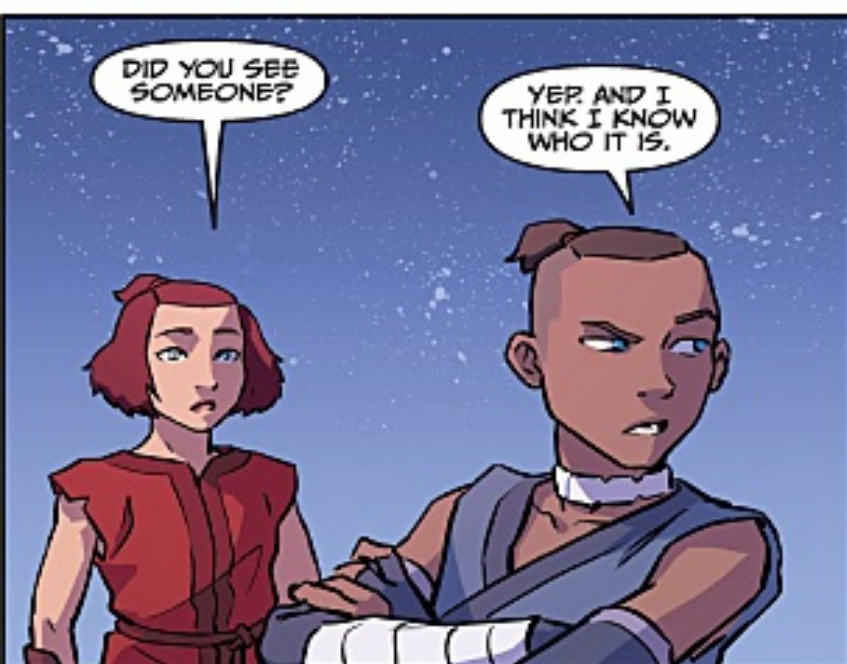
YOU'VE SEEN HOW MACHINES CAN MAKE THINGS BETWEEN BENDERS AND NON-BENDERS A LITTLE MORE EQUAL. SATORU'S A NON-BENDER AND HE CAN MANAGE AN ENTIRE FACTORY BY HIMSELF, SOMETHING THAT WOULD'VE BEEN IMPOSSIBLE WITHOUT THE HELP OF BENDERS ONLY A FEW YEARS AGO.

THE POLLUTION IS AWFUL, AND WE NEED TO FIND A WAY TO DEAL WITH THAT, BUT YOU CAN'T BLAME THE RISE OF BENDER SUPREMACY IN CRANEFISH TOWN ON *MACHINES*.



YOU HAVE TO BLAME IT ON THE BENDERS RUNNING AROUND BURNING DOWN BUILDINGS AND ATTACKING NON-BENDERS.





DID YOU SEE SOMEONE?

YEP, AND I THINK I KNOW WHO IT IS.

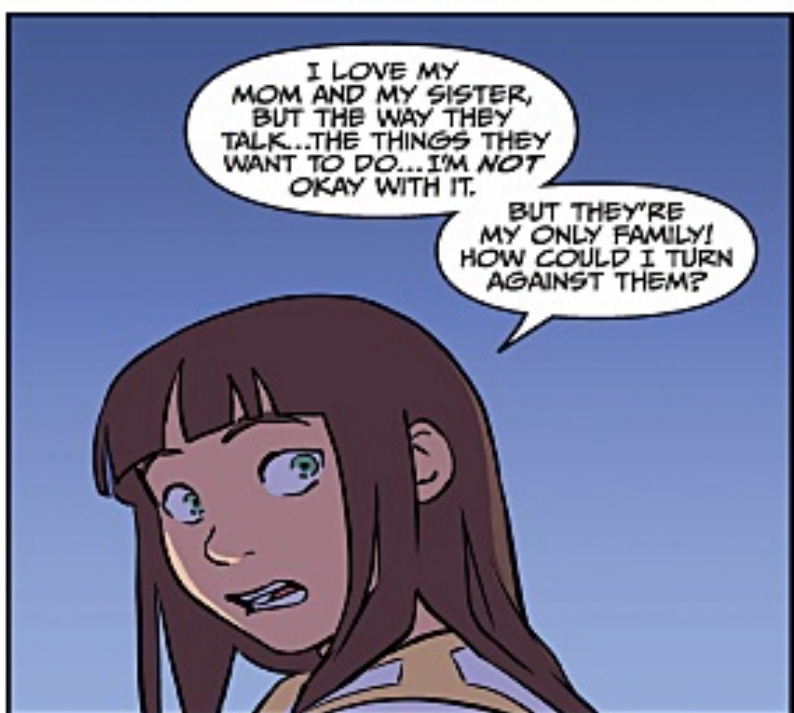


RU?

IS THERE SOMETHING YOU CAME HERE TO TELL ME?



I KEEP THINKING ABOUT WHAT YOU SAID TO ME DURING THAT FIGHT IN THE CAVERN--HOW CAN I BE OKAY WITH WHAT MY MOM IS DOING?



I LOVE MY MOM AND MY SISTER, BUT THE WAY THEY TALK...THE THINGS THEY WANT TO DO...I'M NOT OKAY WITH IT.

BUT THEY'RE MY ONLY FAMILY! HOW COULD I TURN AGAINST THEM?

I KNOW IT'S DIFFICULT, BUT YOU WOULDN'T BE HERE IF YOU DIDN'T BELIEVE WHAT YOUR MOTHER AND SISTER ARE DOING IS WRONG.



I KNOW A GUY WHO WAS ONCE IN A SIMILAR SITUATION. HIS DAD WAS THE WORST DAD EVER, AND WANTED TO CONQUER THE WORLD. IT TOOK A WHILE FOR ZUKO TO STAND UP TO HIS FATHER, BUT EVENTUALLY HE DID. AND THAT'S ONE OF THE REASONS THE HUNDRED YEAR WAR FINALLY ENDED.



YOU HAVE A CHANCE TO DO GOOD. DON'T WASTE IT.





MY MOTHER
IS PLANNING TO
ATTACK EARTHEN
FIRE INDUSTRIES IN
THE MORNING. SHE HAS
DOZENS OF BENDERS
READY TO TAKE ON
THE AVATAR. YOU ALL
SHOULD GET OUT OF
CRANEFISH TOWN
WHILE YOU CAN.



WE'RE NOT
LEAVING.

WE'LL BE
READY FOR HER,
THANKS
TO YOU.



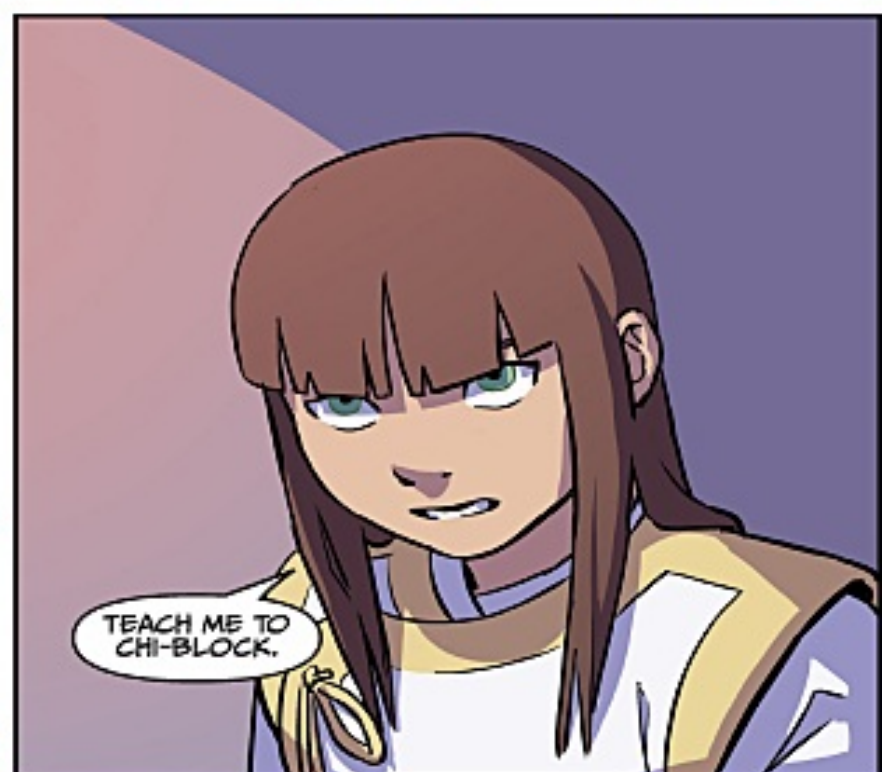
SHE'S STILL
MY MOM. PLEASE,
DON'T HURT HER. JUST
STOP HER FROM
HURTING OTHER
PEOPLE.

WE'LL
DO OUR
BEST.

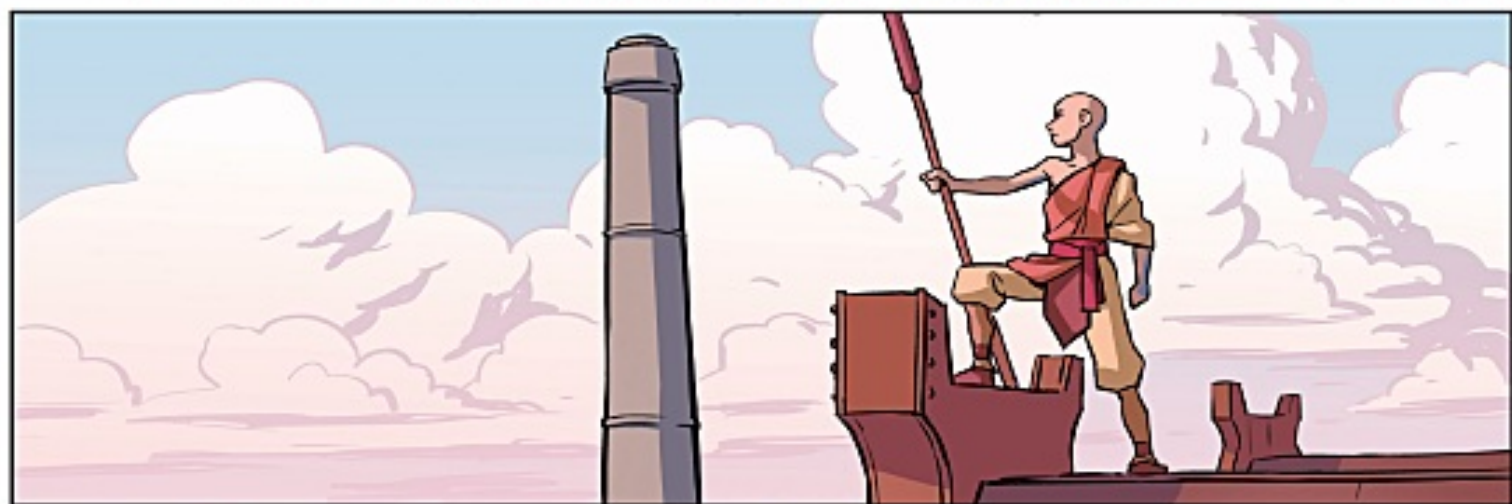
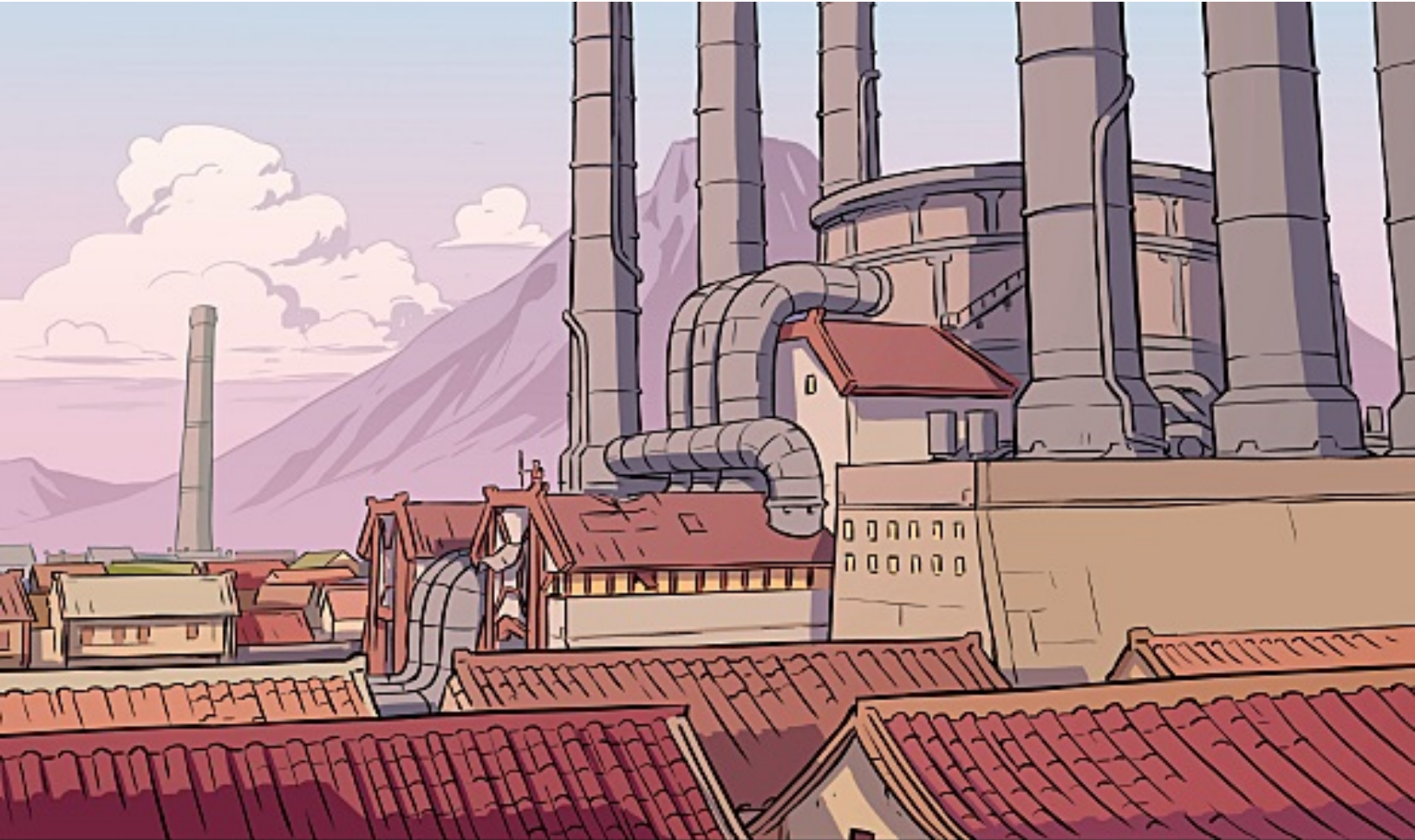


WILL
YOU DO ME
A FAVOR?

WHAT
IS IT?



TEACH ME TO
CHI-BLOCK.





WHAT DO YOU WANT?

TO HELP IF WE CAN. WE'VE SEEN SOME OF OUR NON-BENDER NEIGHBORS LOSE THEIR HOMES, SO WE'VE BROUGHT SUPPLIES FOR THEM.

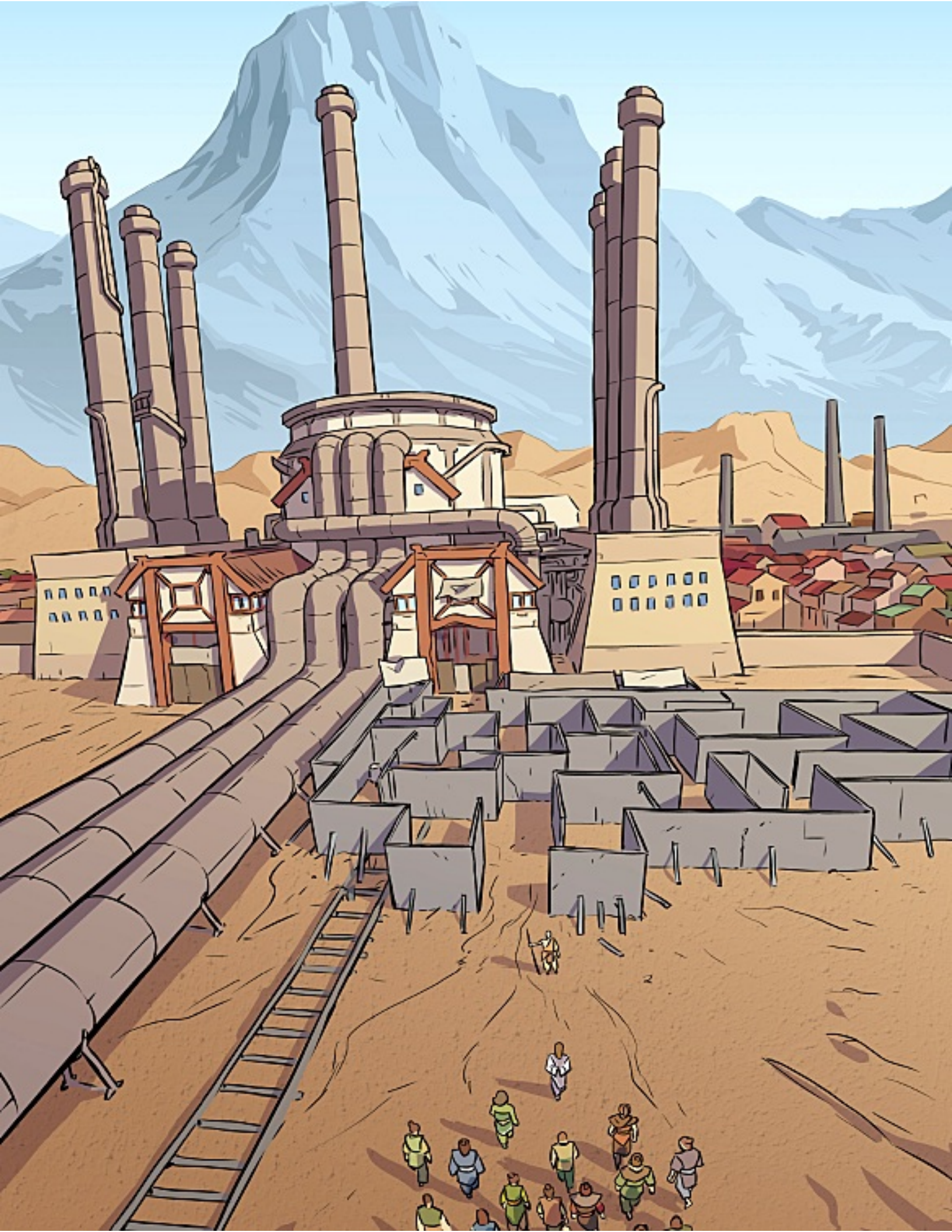


CAN I ASK, ARE YOU BENDERS?

YES, BUT WE'RE NOT THE ONES CAUSING ALL THIS TROUBLE, AVATAR. WE CARE ABOUT THE NON-BENDERS IN CRANEFISH TOWN. WE DON'T WANT TO SEE THEM HURT.









AVATAR AANG,
STILL ON THE
WRONG SIDE,
I SEE.



YOU'RE THE ONE ON THE
WRONG SIDE, LILING.
YOU'VE HURT INNOCENT
PEOPLE AND DRIVEN
FAMILIES OUT OF
THEIR HOMES.

I WON'T
ALLOW YOU TO
HARM ANYONE
ELSE.



I HAVE A VERY SIMPLE
SOLUTION, AVATAR. LEAVE
THIS CITY. TAKE THE
NON-BENDERS WITH YOU.
ALL OF THEM, EVERY
SINGLE NON-BENDER
THAT CURRENTLY
LIVES HERE.

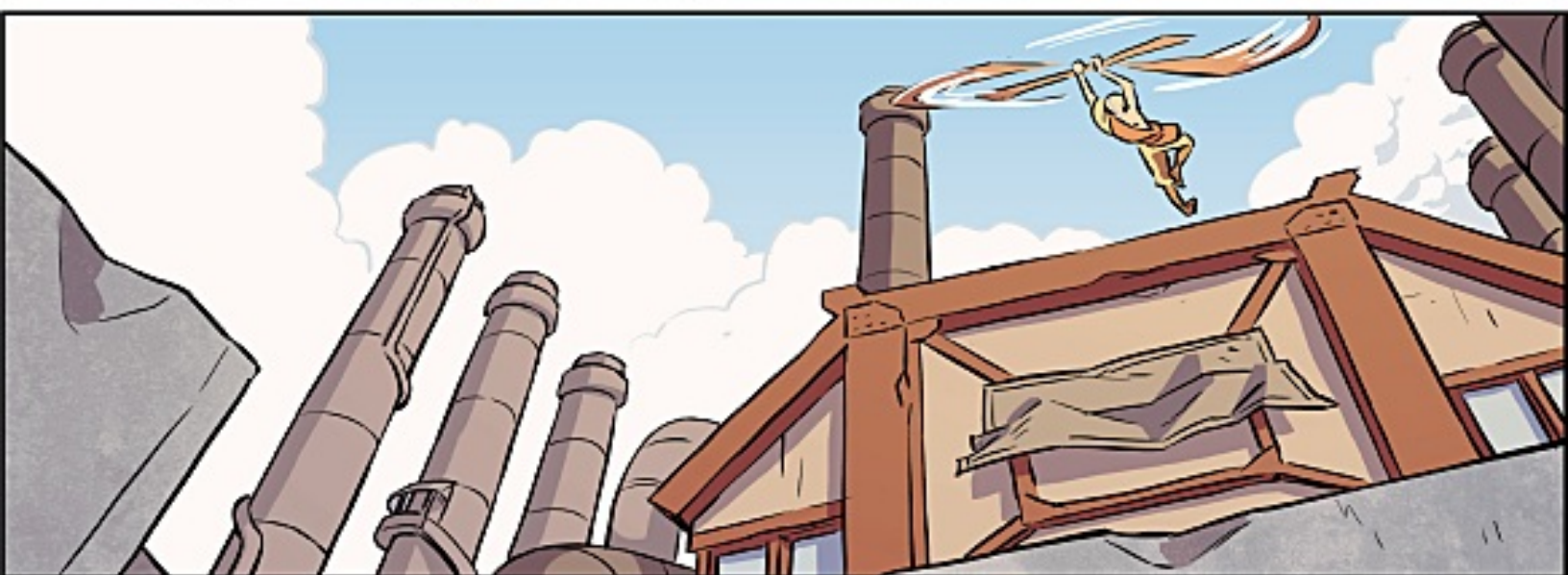
CRANEFISH TOWN
WILL BECOME A CITY
FOR BENDERS ONLY.
WE DESERVE A SPACE
THAT BELONGS TO
US ALONE.

I
CAN'T DO
THAT.

THEN I'LL
HAVE TO FORCE
YOU OUT.

THOOM

SHIIING



HERE
WE GO.





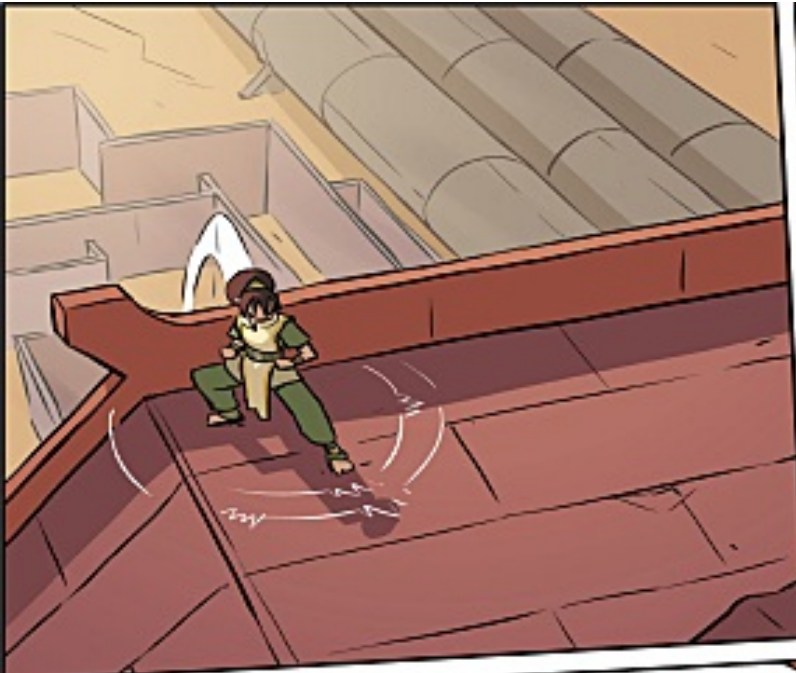








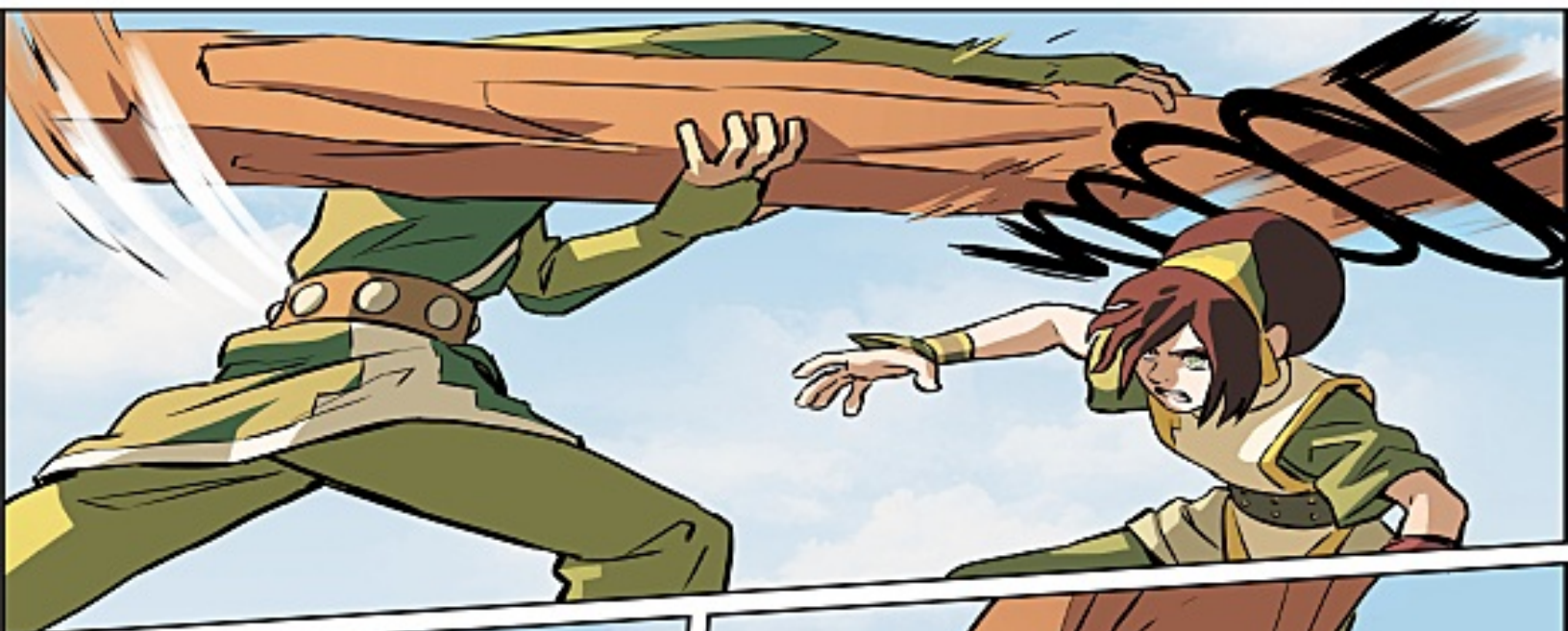












WHAT'S GOING
ON UP THERE? IT'S
LIKE THERE ARE
OSTRICH HORSES
ON THE ROOF!

THUNK
SHUNK

SKREEEE

AND NOW
THE OSTRICH
HORSES ARE
COMING DOWN
HERE???

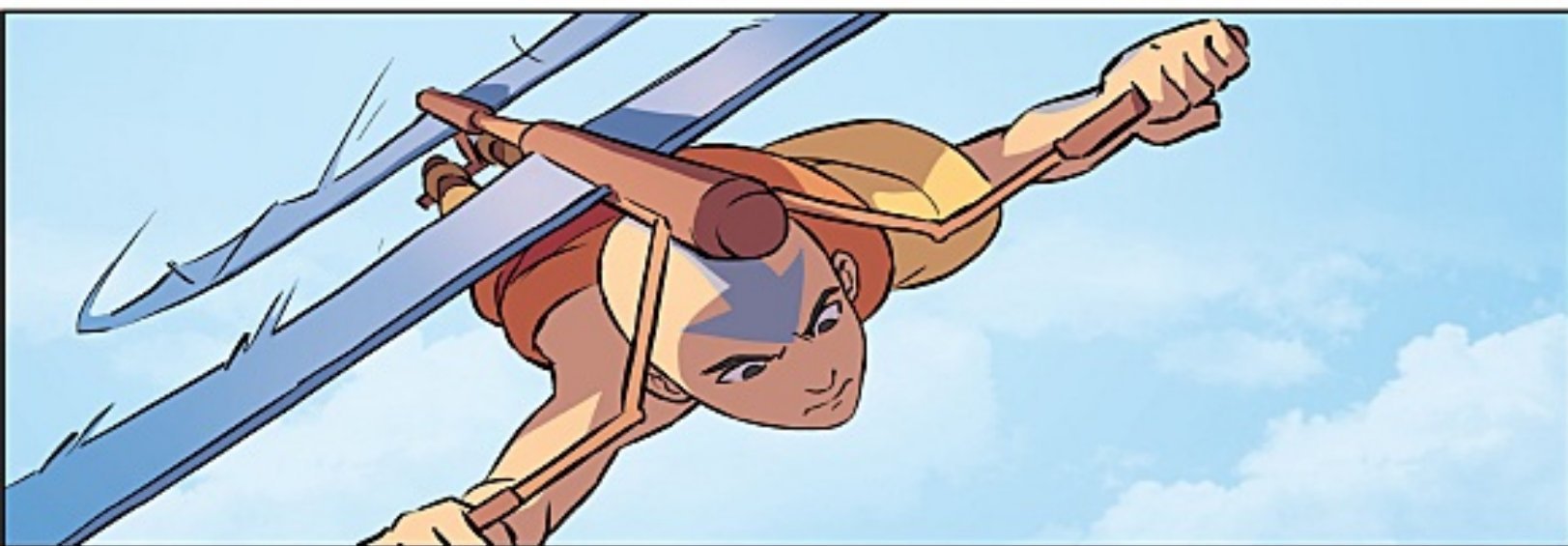
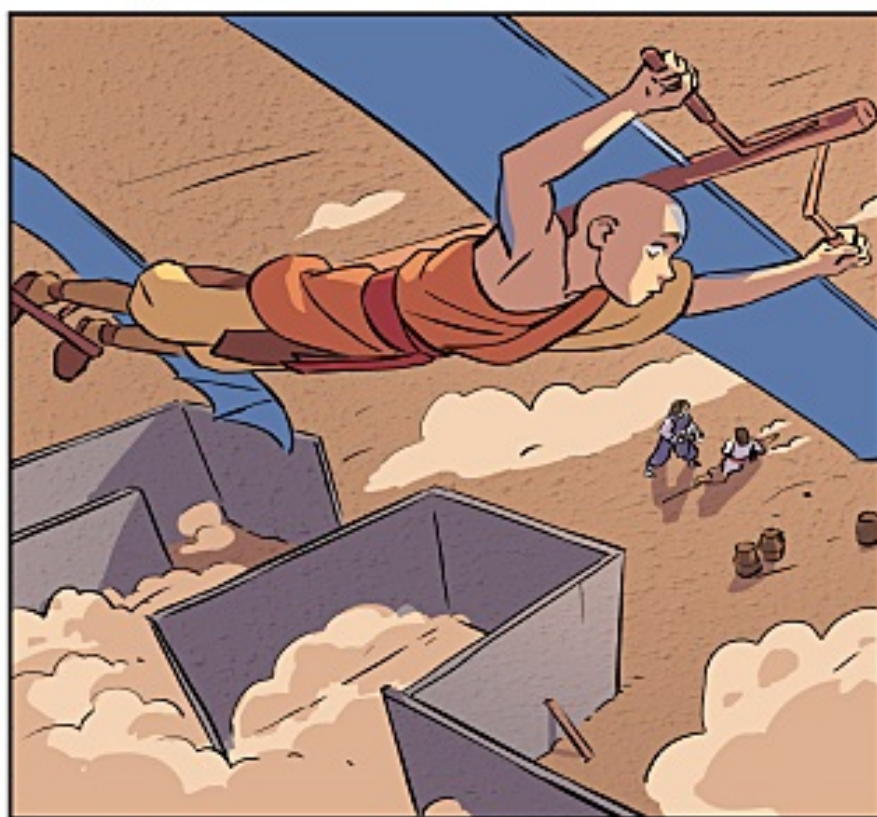
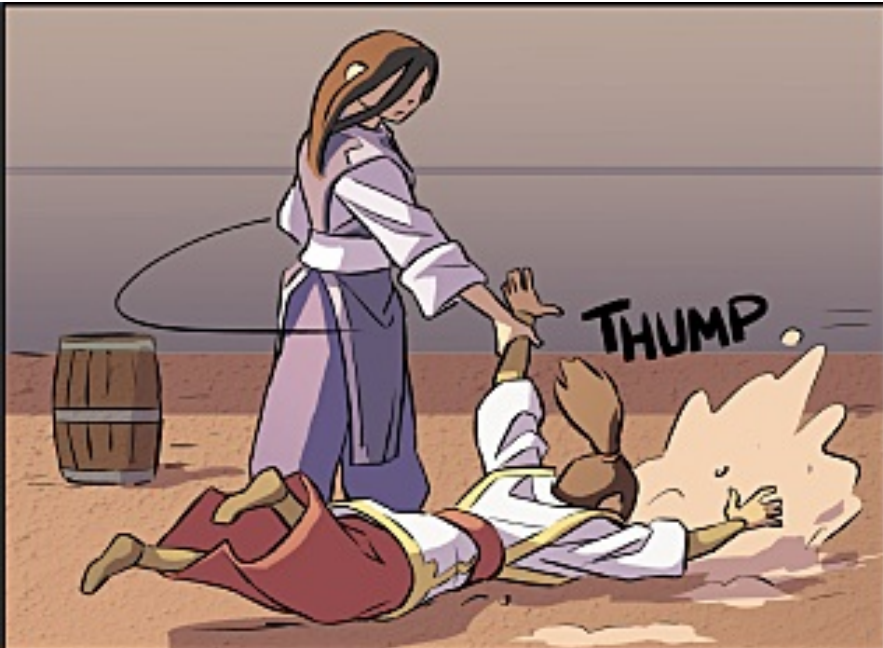


AHHH
LOOK OUT
BELOW!



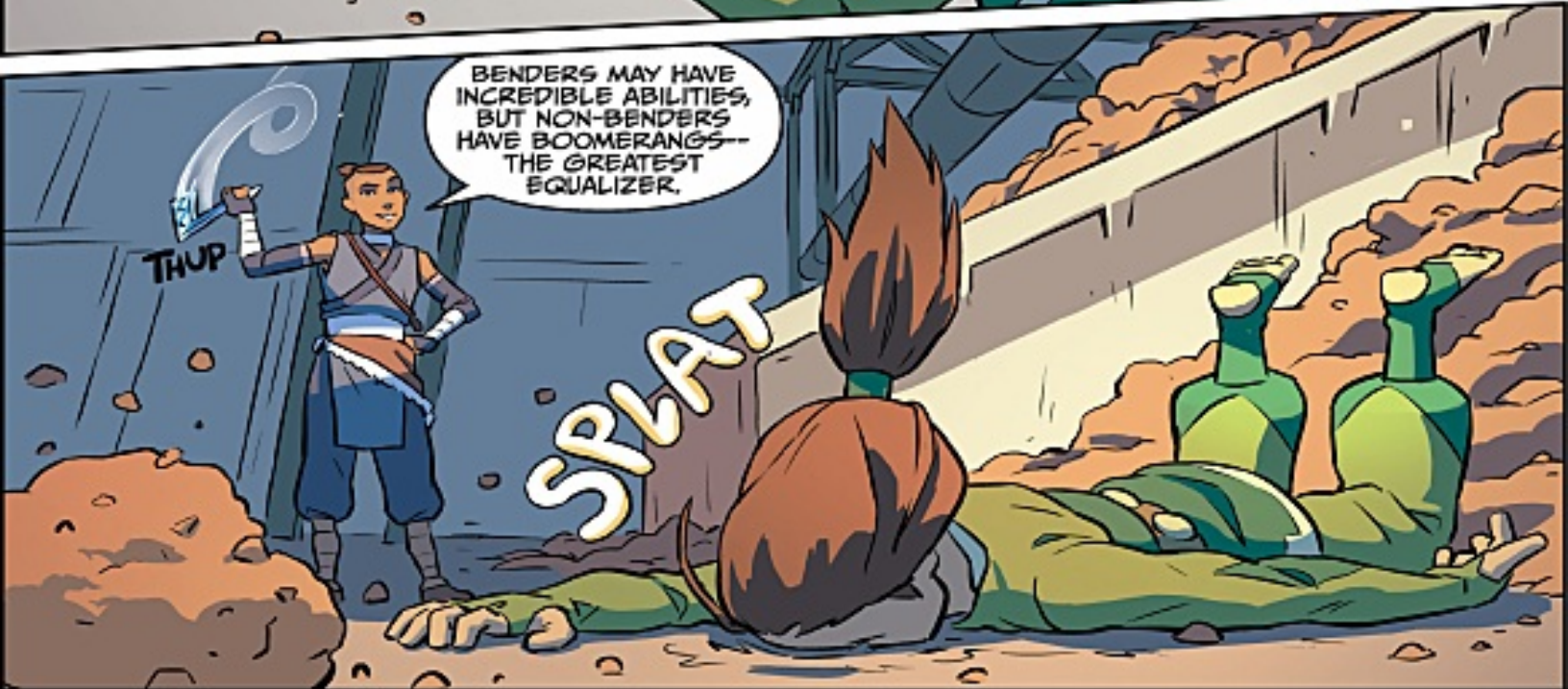
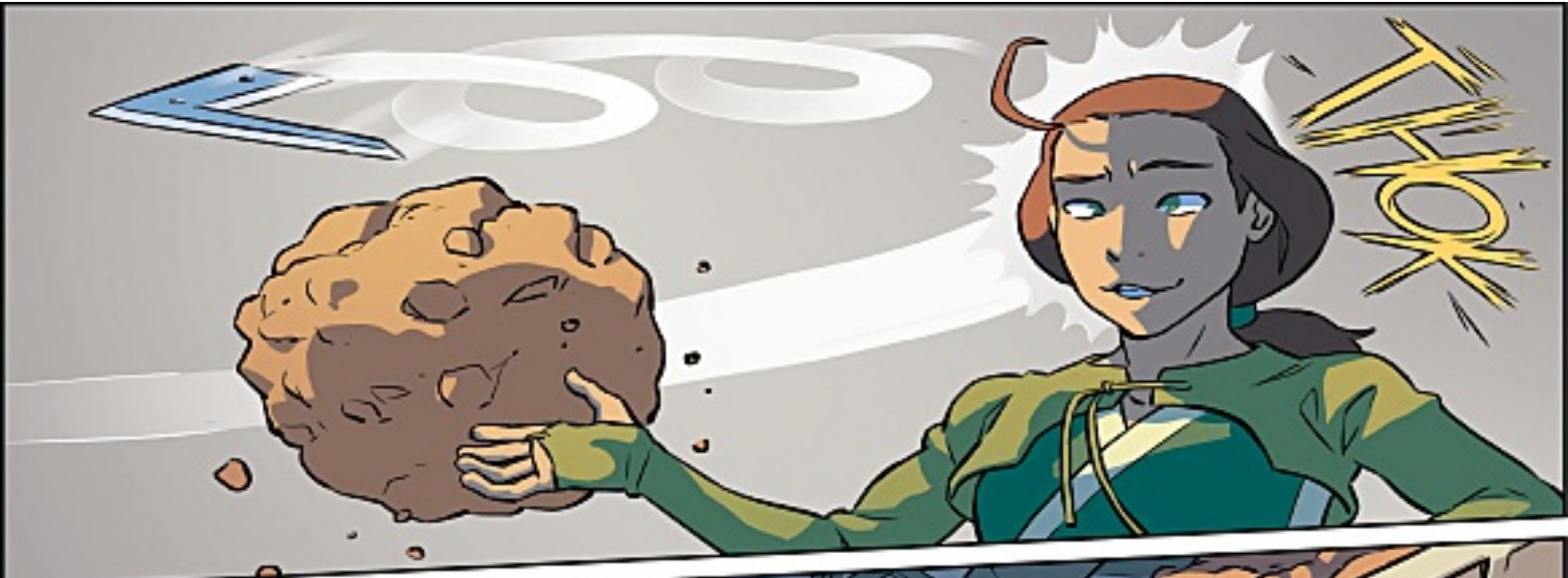


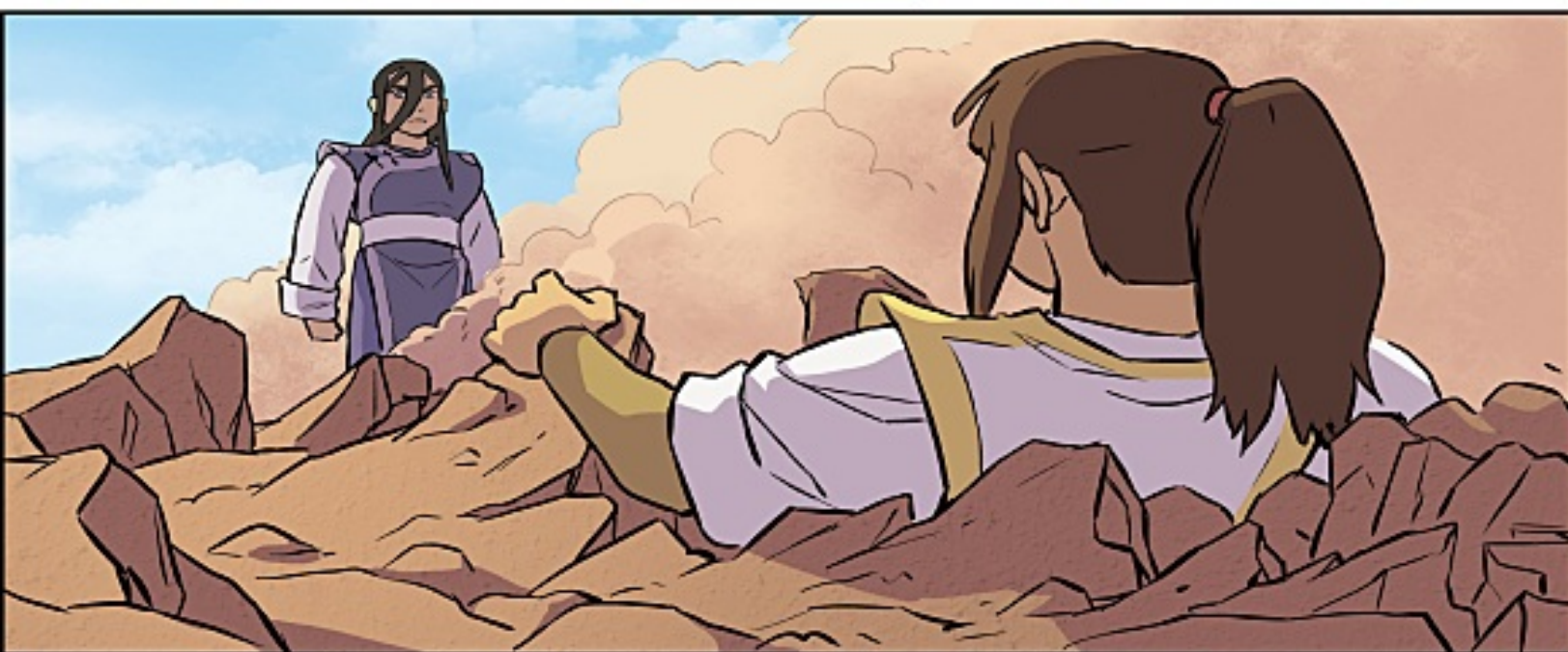
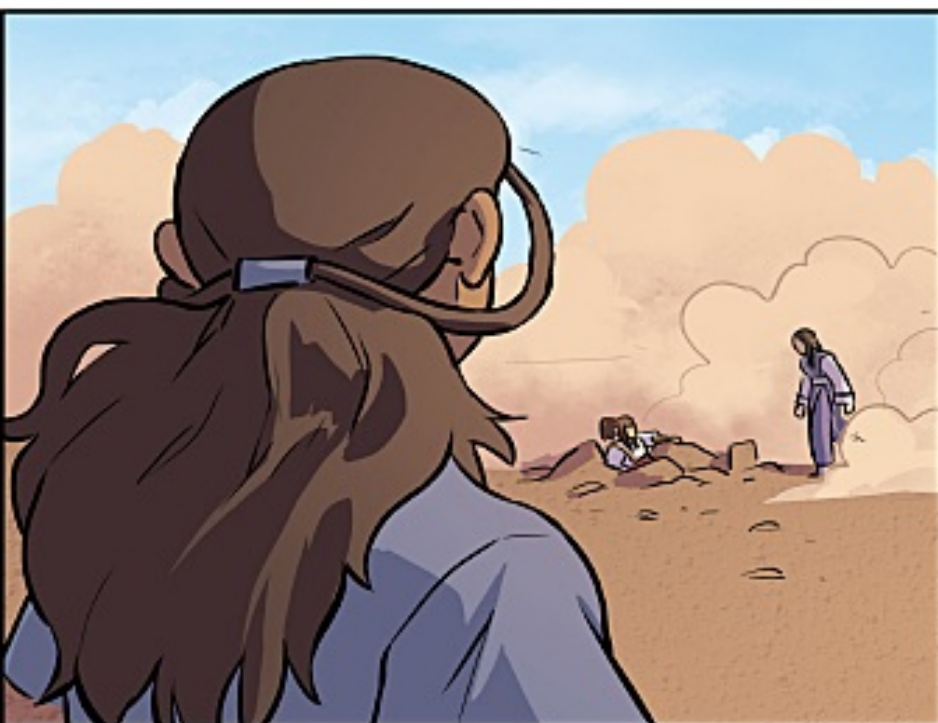










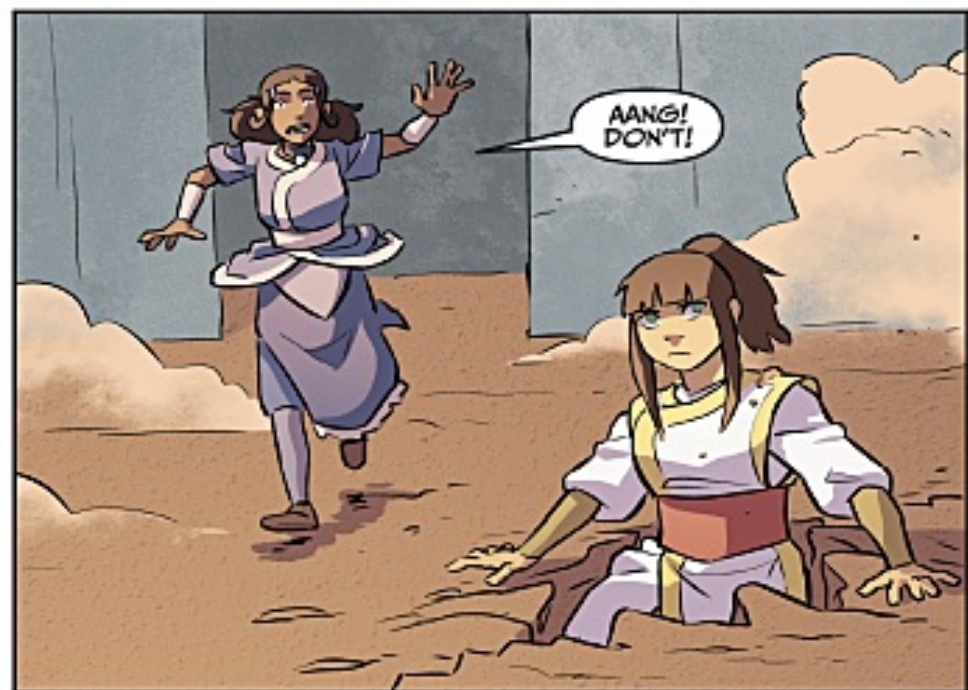




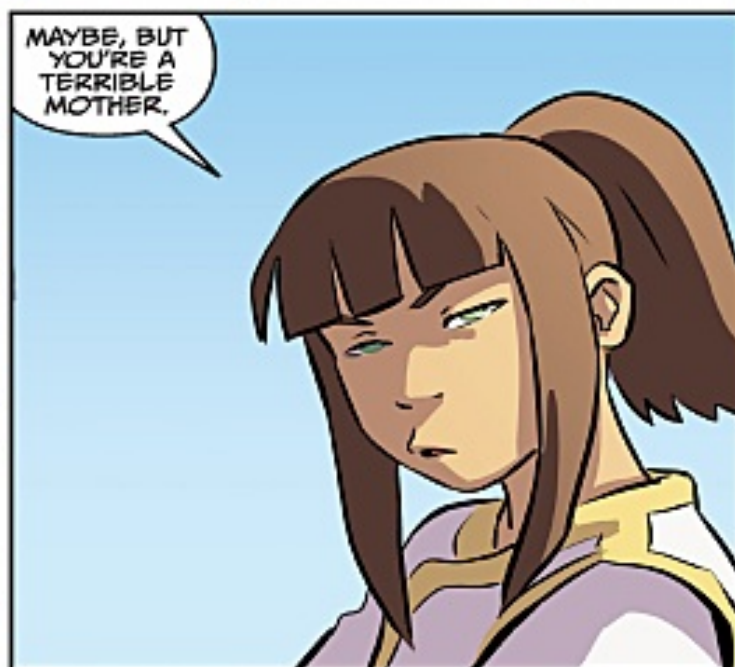
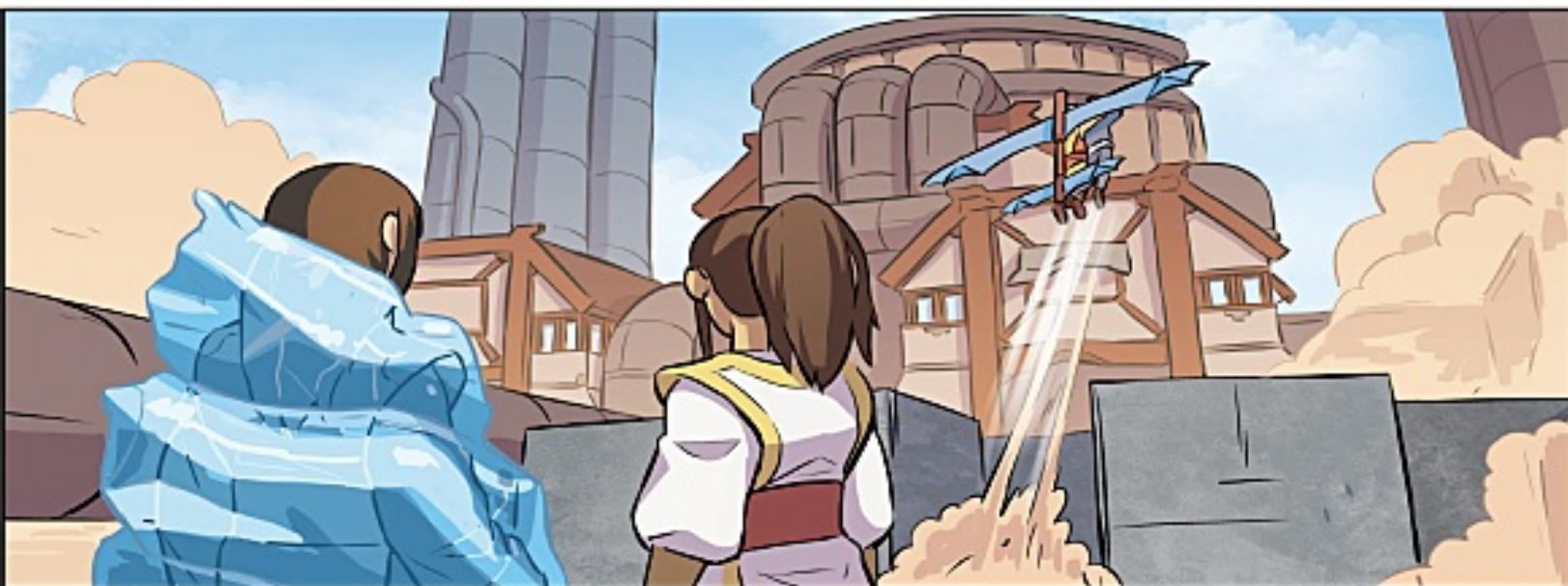


IT DOESN'T
MATTER WHAT YOU DO,
AVATAR. MY MESSAGE WILL
SPREAD TO THE BENDERS OF
THE WORLD. IT'LL EAT UP
EVERY PART OF THIS CITY, AS
OTHER BENDERS STAND UP
FOR THEIR RIGHTS AND DRIVE
OUT THE NON-BENDERS.











GRANTED, IT WILL TAKE SOME TIME TO REBUILD TRUST, BUT IT'S THE ONLY WAY FORWARD.



THE PEOPLE OF CRANEFISH TOWN CANNOT THANK YOU ENOUGH, AVATAR AANG.



RU, HOW ARE YOU FEELING?

I SHOULD BE IN THAT CAGE WITH THEM.





NO, YOU SHOULDN'T.
YOU STOOD UP TO
THEM WHEN YOU
HAD TO.

I
COULD'VE
DONE IT
SOONER.



MAYBE...
BUT IT'S OVER
NOW. ALL THAT'S
LEFT IS TO DECIDE
WHAT YOU WANT
TO DO NEXT.





TOUGH DAY, HUH?

YEAH.



THE LAST TIME WE WERE IN THIS AREA, A SPIRIT WAS THREATENING THE HUMANS WHO LIVED HERE. I CHOSE TO PROTECT THE HUMANS.



THERE WAS A DIVIDE BETWEEN HUMANS AND SPIRITS. I WASN'T ABLE TO BRIDGE THAT DIVIDE. I FAILED.

NOW THERE'S A DIVIDE BETWEEN BENDERS AND NON-BENDERS. I'M NOT SURE HOW TO FIX THAT EITHER.



HEY, YOU BRIDGED THAT DIVIDE WITH ME, DIDN'T YOU? YOU'RE A BENDER, I'M A NON-BENDER AND WE'RE FRIENDS. IT GIVES YOU A LITTLE BIT OF HOPE, DOESN'T IT?



YES, A LITTLE HOPE.



THREE DAYS LATER...



WHAT WAS IT THAT MADE YOU CHANGE YOUR MIND ABOUT TAKING AWAY LILING'S BENDING?

IT WAS WHAT YOU SAID ABOUT IT BEING AN EASY SOLUTION. I THOUGHT THAT SHE COULDN'T LEAD A MOVEMENT AGAINST NON-BENDERS IF SHE WAS A NON-BENDER HERSELF. IT SEEMED SO SIMPLE.



BUT TAKING AWAY HER BENDING WOULDN'T HAVE FIXED ANYTHING. IT WASN'T HER BENDING THAT WAS THE PROBLEM, IT WAS HER BIGOTRY.



IT BOTHERS ME THAT THE BENDERS WHO CLAIMED THEY WEREN'T LILING'S FOLLOWERS DIDN'T DO MORE TO PROTECT THEIR NON-BENDER NEIGHBORS.

YOU ASKED THEM TO FIGHT WITH US, AND THEY REFUSED. THEY STOOD BY AND DID NOTHING TO HELP.



I'VE BEEN THINKING. I WANT TO STAY IN CRANEFISH TOWN FOR NOW. I FEEL A CONNECTION TO THIS PLACE. IT HAS SO MANY PROBLEMS, BUT IF IT WAS ABLE TO OVERCOME THEM, IT COULD BECOME SOMETHING REALLY SPECIAL.

MAYBE WE COULD STAY PUT FOR A WHILE, IF THAT'S OKAY WITH YOU.

I AGREE. THIS CITY NEEDS YOU.

I THINK IT NEEDS US.



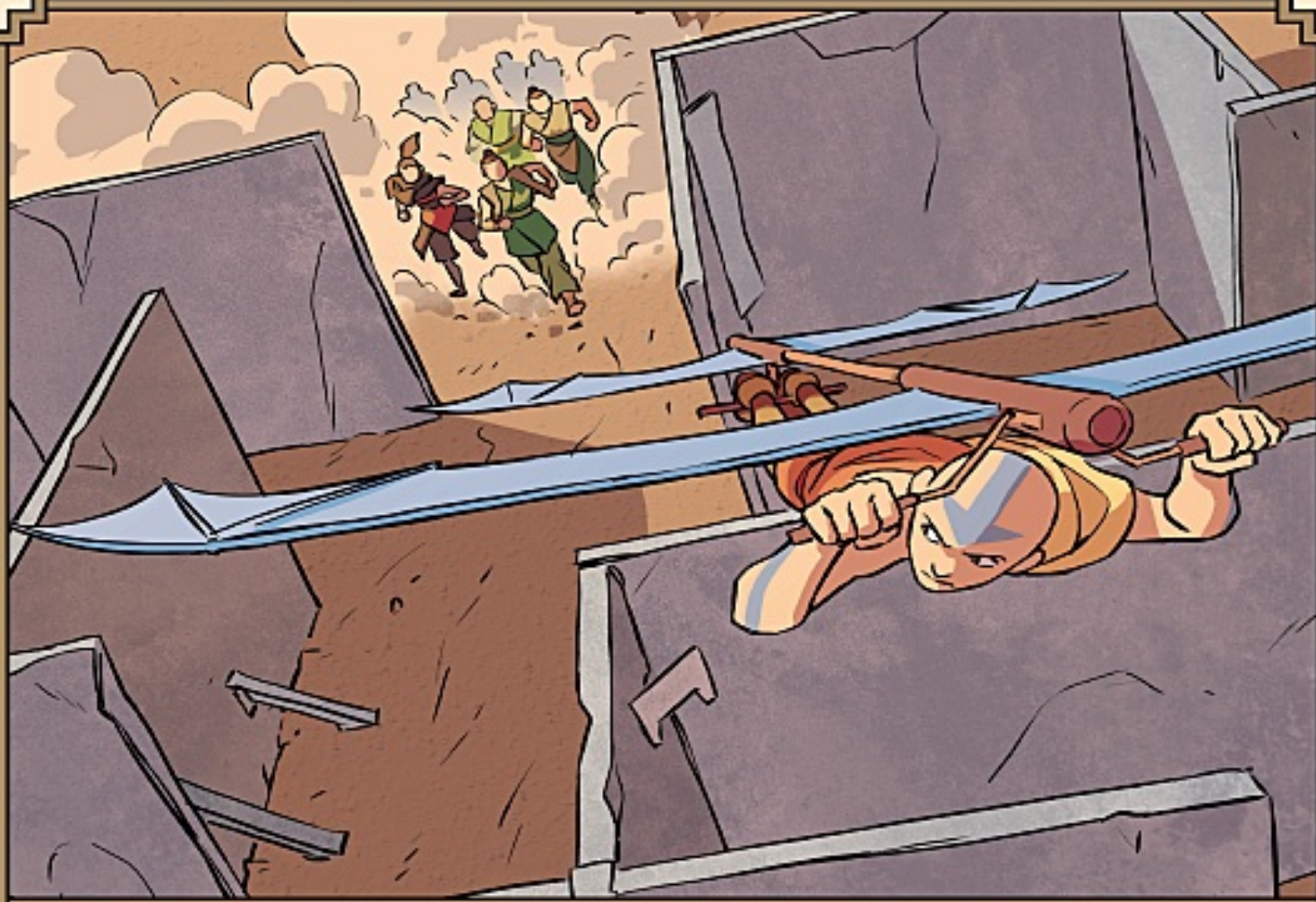


I ALSO
THINK THIS CITY
NEEDS A BETTER
NAME.

I'LL GET
SOKKA ON THAT
RIGHT AWAY.

THE END





Team Avatar face the gravest threat to lasting peace!

While Aang grapples with a life-changing decision that as the Avatar only he can make, Toph and Katara implore him—from opposite sides—to choose a path. Meanwhile, Ru and Yaling concoct a fiery ploy to get their mother back. The bender vs. non-bender conflict finally reaches a powerful boiling point, and for better or for worse, CraneFish Town will never be the same!

Written by Faith Erin Hicks (*The Nameless City*) and drawn by Peter Wartman (*Over The Wall*), in collaboration with *Avatar: The Last Airbender* and *Legend of Korra* creators Michael Dante DiMartino and Bryan Konietzko, this is the ultimate continuation of *Avatar* and the perfect companion to *Legend of Korra*!



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SON OF ULTRON

"THIS FAN...
THIS MONSTER!"

